

IEP Vendor Marketplace Growth Strategy

Executive Summary

The IEP Vendor Marketplace connects Event Organizers, Professional Event Planners, Venue Owners, Hospitality Providers, Hosts, and Partners with trusted event-related businesses.

The objective is to create a self-sustaining ecosystem where:

- Event planners find vendors
- Vendors generate qualified leads
- Hosts discover trusted services
- IEP earns recurring revenue
- Partners gain visibility

The Marketplace should become the preferred destination for sourcing event resources and managing vendor relationships.

Marketplace Vision

Mission

Help event professionals find, evaluate, communicate with, and hire event vendors from within the planning workflow.

Instead of searching multiple websites, users can discover and engage vendors directly inside IEP.

Vendor Categories

Phase 1 (Launch)

Venues

- Hotels
 - Banquet Halls
 - Conference Centers
 - Outdoor Venues
 - Wedding Venues
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Hospitality Providers

- Caterers
 - Bartending Services
 - Food Trucks
 - Private Chefs
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Event Services

- Photographers
 - Videographers
 - DJs
 - Bands
 - Entertainment Providers
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Event Rentals

- Furniture Rentals

- Tents
 - Lighting
 - Audio Equipment
 - Decor Rentals
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Transportation

- Shuttle Services
 - Limousines
 - Charter Buses
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Phase 2 Expansion

Business Services

- Insurance Providers
 - Security Services
 - Staffing Agencies
 - Cleaning Services
 - Permit Consultants
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Marketing Services

- Promotional Products
- Social Media Agencies
- Print Services
- Influencer Partnerships

Marketplace Revenue Model

Tier 1 – Free Vendor Listing

Purpose:

Acquire vendors quickly.

Includes:

- Vendor profile
- Contact information
- Category placement

Tier 2 – Featured Vendor

Monthly Subscription

Includes:

- Featured placement
- Preferred search ranking
- Priority visibility
- Enhanced profile

Suggested Pricing:

\$49–\$99/month

Tier 3 – Premium Partner

Includes:

- Homepage placement
- Lead analytics
- Marketplace advertising
- Performance reporting

Suggested Pricing:

\$199–\$499/month

Tier 4 – Transaction Revenue

Future Opportunity

Charge:

- Lead generation fees

or

- Booking commissions

Suggested Range:

3–8%

Vendor Acquisition Strategy

Stage 1 – Build Initial Supply

Target:

First 100 Vendors

Focus on:

- Local event businesses

- Existing planner relationships
 - Venue partnerships
 - Hospitality providers
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Outreach Campaign

Channels:

- LinkedIn
 - Facebook Groups
 - Chamber of Commerce
 - Event Associations
 - Wedding Associations
 - Hospitality Associations
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Vendor Invitation Message

Subject:

Grow Your Event Business with IEP

Message:

Join the IEP Vendor Marketplace and connect directly with event planners, hosts, and organizations actively planning events.

Create your profile and start receiving qualified opportunities today.

Marketplace Demand Generation

Attract Event Planners

Create landing pages around:

- Wedding Planning
 - Corporate Events
 - Fundraisers
 - Conferences
 - Festivals
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Planner Benefits

- Save sourcing time
 - Compare vendors
 - Track proposals
 - Manage contracts
 - Centralize communications
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Search and Discovery Strategy

Every vendor profile should include:

Business Information

- Company name
 - Contact information
 - Service area
 - Description
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Marketplace Filters

Users should search by:

- Category
 - Location
 - Price Range
 - Availability
 - Ratings
 - Specialty
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Trust Building System

Trust is essential.

Each vendor profile should display:

Verification Status

Verified Vendor

Background Verified

Licensed Business

Insurance Confirmed

Reviews

Collect:

- Planner Reviews
 - Host Reviews
 - Venue Reviews
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Performance Metrics

Display:

- Response Time
 - Booking Rate
 - Completion Rate
 - Customer Satisfaction
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Vendor Onboarding Funnel

Step 1

Vendor Creates Account

Step 2

Business Verification

Step 3

Complete Marketplace Profile

Step 4

Add Portfolio

Step 5

Activate Listing

Vendor Profile Structure

Profile Header

Logo

Company Name

Location

Categories

Verification Status

About Section

Company Description

Experience

Specialties

Portfolio Section

Images

Videos

Previous Events

Reviews Section

Ratings

Testimonials

Completed Projects

Marketplace SEO Strategy

Create vendor landing pages indexed by search engines.

Examples:

/vendors/photographers

/vendors/caterers

/vendors/wedding-venues

/vendors/event-rentals

/vendors/maryland-photographers

/vendors/corporate-caterers

Benefits:

- Organic traffic
 - Vendor discovery
 - Lead generation
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Marketplace Success Metrics

Supply Metrics

Target Year 1

- 500 Vendors
- 50 Premium Vendors
- 20 Premium Partners

Demand Metrics

Target Year 1

- 5,000 Marketplace Searches
 - 1,000 Vendor Inquiries
 - 250 Vendor Bookings
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Revenue Metrics

Target Year 1

Vendor Subscription Revenue:

\$25,000+

Premium Listings Revenue:

\$15,000+

Marketplace Revenue:

\$40,000+

Recommended Launch Roadmap

Month 1

Launch Marketplace MVP

Goal:

100 Vendors

Month 2

Launch Vendor Referral Program

Goal:

200 Vendors

Month 3

Launch Featured Vendor Subscriptions

Goal:

20 Paid Vendors

Month 4–6

Launch Reviews, Ratings, and Verification

Goal:

500 Vendors

Long-Term Vision

The IEP Marketplace becomes the central ecosystem connecting event professionals, venues, hospitality providers, service vendors, retailers, and partners.

Every event planned within IEP creates opportunities for vendors to gain business and for planners to discover trusted resources.

The result is a network effect where more vendors attract more planners, and more planners attract more vendors, creating sustainable recurring revenue growth for the IEP platform.